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Olipop Brand Audit

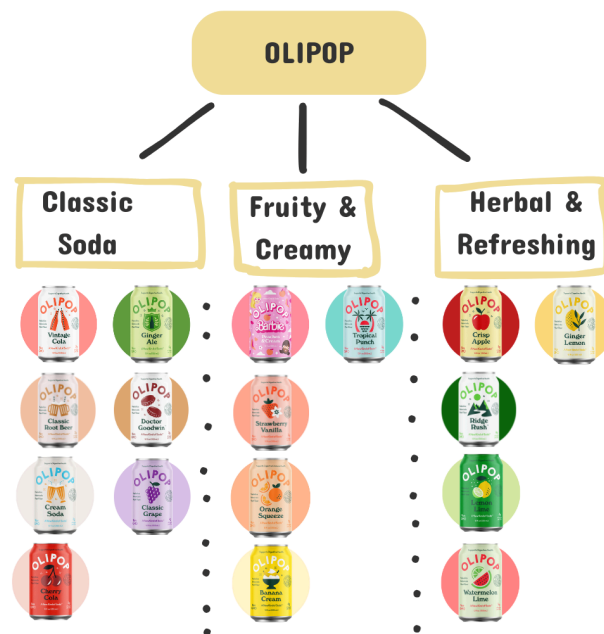
Introduction

Brand History. Olipop was founded in 2018 by Ben Goodwin and David Lester with a mission to transform the soda industry by offering a healthier, functional alternative to traditional sugary beverages. Previously having worked at a kombucha company, Goodwin gained experience in the health beverage industry and used his knowledge of prebiotic ingredients to create Olipop: a similarly healthy drink that actually tastes good too. The brand combines the nostalgia of classic soda flavors with modern health benefits, incorporating prebiotics, botanicals, and plant fiber to promote gut health. Its unique approach to recreating soda with high-quality ingredients and a focus on holistic wellness quickly differentiated it from other functional beverages. Since its inception, Olipop has grown rapidly, securing distribution in premium retailers like Whole Foods and Trader Joe's and building a strong presence in the direct-to-consumer market. The brand's visually distinct, pastel-colored packaging and emphasis on nostalgic flavors have further established it as a standout product in the health-conscious beverage space.

Target Market. Olipop's target market consists of young, health-conscious, and high-income consumers who are drawn to products that combine indulgence with wellness. These individuals value high-quality, functional ingredients but still crave the familiar, nostalgic flavors of traditional soda. Olipop appeals to a younger demographic, including millennials and

Gen Z, who are active on social media and prioritize brands that align with their holistic health values. Additionally, the brand resonates with those who enjoy premium, innovative products and are willing to pay a higher price for beverages that support their wellness goals. Olipop's focus on bridging indulgence and functionality allows it to attract a unique audience looking for a modern, elevated soda experience.

Product Portfolio. Olipop's product portfolio is a unified line of functional beverages with a focus on nostalgia, flavor, and wellness. Its offerings can be categorized into three distinct groups based on flavor profiles and the emotional or functional benefits they provide. The "Classic Soda" group features familiar, nostalgic options like Vintage Cola, Classic Root Beer, and Doctor Goodwin (Olipop's version of Dr. Pepper), designed to replicate traditional soda flavors with a healthier twist. The "Fruity & Creamy" category encapsulates the taste of a summer-time creamsicle, including indulgent choices like Orange Squeeze, Strawberry Vanilla, and Peaches & Cream, which appeal to those seeking both refreshing and rich flavor combinations. Finally, the "Herbal & Refreshing" category showcases flavors like Ginger Lemon, Crisp Apple, and Lemon Lime, highlighting Olipop's focus on prebiotics, botanicals, and overall gut health. The comprehensive portfolio below balances nostalgia and innovation, offering something for every taste preference while maintaining its health-conscious ethos.



Brand Inventory

Products. Olipop offers soda alternative beverages which utilize prebiotics, fiber, and plant-based ingredients to deliver a delicious beverage which supports digestive health; it belongs to the “functional beverage” category. Olipop strives to offer a drink which tastes virtually indistinguishable from a sugar-filled soda beverage, while minimizing harmful ingredients and maximizing health benefits. Olipop’s beverages offer flavors which recreate classic soda flavors with more subtle, nostalgic tastes. Competing brands include Poppi, which offer products with similar goals, yet slightly different ingredients and approaches. Poppi mainly utilizes apple cider vinegar, an ingredient beneficial for digestion. However, Olipop distinguishes itself with its utilization of a variety of digestion-supportive ingredients such as various pre-biotics, botanicals, fiber, and low-sugar content. Poppi relies more on the trending interest in the known benefits of apple cider vinegar and markets to an audience interested in digestion and weight loss, while Olipop focuses more on a holistic blend of ingredients marketed to individuals looking to improve overall health and wellness along with digestion (Sommers, 2023). This

aligns with the growing health consciousness among consumers, who prioritize brands which focus on added health benefits. The brand emphasizes the use of natural ingredients, avoiding artificial sweeteners and flavors which is a significant consideration for consumers increasingly concerned about additives and processed foods (Chychula, 2023).

Brand elements. Olipop utilizes a mix of brand elements to convey its brand to consumers, including a brand name, logo, strategic packaging design, and a tagline. The brand name “Olipop” is a thoughtfully crafted combination of the prefix “Oli”, derived from the prebiotic fiber named oligosaccharide, and the suffix “pop”, which is a common name for soda in the United States (Olipop). Therefore, Olipop essentially conveys that their product is a “prebiotic soda”.

Furthermore, Olipop’s logo utilizes a retro-inspired font and pastel color scheme which evokes a nostalgic feel which mimics the look and taste of old-fashioned, classic soda, extremely popular in mid-20th century American culture. This is also seen in their flavors, which are remakes of classic sodas such as Classic Root Beer, Vintage Cola, and Cherry Vanilla. As well, each flavor has a distinct color scheme associated with it, again utilizing pastel and “vintage” colors which enhance product differentiation and visual appeal.



Figure 01. Image displaying various Olipop flavors and their can’s packaging design.

Olipop also uses the tagline, “A New Kind of Soda”, which directly reinforces their brand image and product differentiation, in that while the sodas have the same nostalgic feel and, ideally, taste of classic soda, they are different in that they contain beneficial ingredients and contain less harmful ones in that of classic soda such as sugar (Garcia, 2024).

Of these differentiating brand elements, the most prominent is the packaging design. The visual elements of the nostalgic, pastel colors and fonts, combined with the distinct colors and designs associated with each flavor, help to communicate Olipop’s unique selling proposition, of a soda which maintains the feel of classic soda that consumers love but with health benefits that are becoming more important as individuals become more health conscious. Olipop’s packaging maintains a consistent look and feel, with distinct differences in each flavor which engage different consumer’s while maintaining a unified brand image (Garcia, 2024).

Pricing. The pricing strategy of Olipop reflects its positioning within the market, as a premium beverage which caters to the desires of consumers for a new soda which simultaneously provides functional health benefits and a nostalgic feel of traditional flavors. Olipop positions itself with its pricing as a superior beverage with clean, natural ingredients including prebiotics and botanicals. By charging a higher price, Olipop maintains its high brand value proposition as well as its target market as higher-income individuals, who are willing to pay a higher price for a better product.

Traditional sodas cost significantly less than health-based sodas like Olipop. For example, at Target, a single 12 oz fluid can of Olipop costs \$2.49, compared to an average cost of \$1.00 per 12 fluid oz can of traditional soda (Target). This means that Olipop’s, on average, cost nearly 2.5x more than traditional sodas. Therefore, Olipop charges a premium for their product.

Despite this higher price point, Olipop maintains a strong demand with consumers as their unique value proposition justifies the higher price as it is a premium product with elevated ingredients and benefits. The typical Olipop consumer is a higher-income, wellness-focused individual who is likely willing to pay a higher price for a soda which aligns with their lifestyle goals. This demographic, specifically, often shops at stores with higher overall prices as they are focused on premium products with health benefits. For example, stores like WholeFoods sell Olipop, and their consumers share the same characteristics as those of Olipop. Therefore, the pricing strategy of Olipop, although significantly higher than traditional sodas, is strategically aligned with their brand image, their unique value offering, and their target market as a whole.

Distribution. Olipop uses a multi-faceted distribution strategy that encompasses direct-to-consumer (DTC) online sales, indirect retail partnerships, and foodservice collaborations. This diverse approach aligns with its target market of health conscious consumers seeking convenient access to functional beverages.

Olipop's DTC channel allows consumers to purchase products directly from its website, offering subscription services that deliver right to consumers' front doorstep. This model caters to consumers who prefer online shopping and value the convenience of home delivery. The DTC approach also allows Olipop to gather consumer data, fostering personalized marketing and product development. The COVID-19 pandemic served as a period of significant growth for Olipop, highlighting the importance of having convenient online options like their subscription service to reach customers during periods of restricted retail access (Kats, 2021).

Additionally, Olipop has secured many indirect retail partnerships to distribute their product. Olipop has established relationships with high-end retailers, such as Target, Sprouts, Whole Foods, and Wegmans, significantly expanding its market reach. By positioning

themselves within high-end grocery stores Olipop further reinforces its imaging as a premium product. In January 2022, Olipop launched in 1,569 Target stores across the United States, with four of its top-selling flavors available for single-can purchase within the produce aisle (Bevnet, 2022). As of halfway through the 2023 calendar year, Olipop expanded its territory into a total of 25,000 retail stores throughout the nation, reflecting their extensive retail distribution market. These grocery store partnerships enhance their brand visibility and accessibility, allowing health-conscious consumers to purchase Olipop products conveniently during routine grocery errands.

Expanding beyond retail stores, Olipop has also entered the realm of the foodservice industry through partnerships with establishments such as Sweetgreen and Starbucks. In 2023, Olipop announced that its Vintage Cola and Lemon Lime flavors would be sold in all Sweetgreen locations across the United States (Bevnet, 2022). Additionally, Olipop's Classic Root Beer and Classic Grape flavors have recently launched in Starbucks (Starbucks, 2024). These collaborations introduce Olipop to consumers in dining environments that align with its health-focused and premium brand image, further reinforcing its targeted consumer base.

The combination of DTC online sales, extensive retail partnerships, and strategic foodservice collaborations ensures that health-conscious and high-income consumers have convenient access to Olipop products, whether shopping online, visiting grocery stores, or dining out. This comprehensive approach supports brand growth and aligns with consumer purchasing behaviors.

Marketing and Communication Strategy. Olipop uses a variety of communication strategies to promote its brand, including advertising on streaming platforms, influencer partnerships, sponsorships, and philanthropy. Each campaign highlights the brand's focus on

health, community, and creativity, with strategic secondary brand associations to reinforce its equity.

The “Real Love Makes Us” campaign, starring Camila Cabello, premiered on May 2, 2023. It was broadcasted across Hulu, Peacock, Tiktok, Youtube, and Facebook, leveraging a mix of streaming platforms and social media to maximize reach (Bain, 2023). This multi-channel strategy ensured that Olipop reached both younger and health-conscious demographics who consume media on these platforms. The campaign included a professionally produced video ad featuring Camila Cabello and her family sharing moments of bonding and laughter. Soda has traditionally been a symbol of social connection, family bonding, and friendship—yet this representation masks the unfriendly truth of soda’s horrible health consequences. By aligning with the same nostalgic feeling of traditional soda, Olipop reinforces that their brand brings customers that same experience except without a facade, instead emphasizing “real” love due to its good-for-you ingredients. The deeper meaning to this ad allowed Olipop to build emotional resonance with viewers. Camila Cabello’s role as the campaign’s face helped Olipop tap into her global fan base, further enhancing its appeal to younger consumers who relate to her authentic persona. According to Pew Research Center, Gen Z is the most ethnically and racially diverse generation in America to date. One in four Gen Z-ers are hispanic, which makes it extremely valuable for Olipop to target this large percentage of their consumer base. Olipop successfully accomplished this by highlighting Camila Cabello’s Cuban-Mexican culture through her conversations in Spanish with her family at the dinner table and her loving interactions with her abuela. This partnership transferred Camila Cabello’s positive attributes, such as authenticity and cultural relevance, to Olipop, strengthening the brand’s identity as a modern, health-focused beverage choice. The “Real Love Makes Us” campaign also incorporated a philanthropic

component. For every “Pair & Share” 12-pack sold, Olipop donated \$2 to the Partnership for a Healthier America, with a goal of providing up to 140,000 servings of fruits and vegetables to families in need (LBBOnline, 2023). Not only did Olipop show their commitment to giving back to underprivileged communities through their secondary brand association with Partnership for a Healthier America, but by specifically donating fruits and vegetables Olipop reinforced their health-conscious brand image.

In 2023, Olipop also partnered with the Kansas City Current, a team in the National Women’s Soccer League, as an official sponsor. This collaboration marked Olipop’s entry into the world of sports sponsorships. As part of this partnership, Olipop gained pouring rights in the Kansas City Current’s newly constructed stadium, giving the brand significant visibility during games (Myers, 2024). The sponsorship aligns with Olipop’s brand positioning by associating it with athletics and an active, health-conscious lifestyle. The partnership transferred the values of teamwork, athleticism, and empowerment from the Kansas City Current to Olipop, reinforcing its appeal to consumers who value wellness and inclusivity.

In celebration of Barbie’s 65th anniversary, Olipop launched a limited edition Peaches & Cream flavor in partnership with Mattel. This collaboration debuted alongside the Barbie movie release, creating an iconic moment for both brands. The campaign was promoted heavily on social media platforms, including TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook. Visual content emphasized the soda’s vibrant pink packaging, designed to evoke nostalgia and complement the Barbie theme (Castrodale, 2024). As for secondary brand associations, the partnership with Mattel and the Barbie franchise allowed Olipop to connect with multigenerational audiences, drawing on the nostalgia and cultural significance of Barbie while aligning with the playful and aspirational values of the brand.

Olipop has effectively utilized influencer marketing to enhance brand awareness and engagement, particularly through strategic partnerships on platforms like TikTok. A notable example is their collaboration with TikTok influencer Calee Shea, known for her healthy lifestyle content. She regularly shares videos highlighting her wellness routine along with diet recipes, which led her to post a recipe for the “sleepy girl mocktail”. In this mocktail she combines tart cherry juice with Olipop’s Lemon Ginger flavor to promote better sleep (Hicks, 2024). This content resonated with her audience, leading to a resurgence of the flavor’s popularity and increased visibility for Olipop. This partnership exemplifies Olipop’s strategy of integrating its products into authentic, user-generated content that aligns with the lifestyles and interests of its target consumers. By collaborating with influencers whose audiences value health and wellness, Olipop effectively positions itself within relevant consumer conversations, enhancing brand credibility and appeal. Collaborations with TikTok creators such as Calee Shea also serve as secondary brand associations, linking Olipop with her personal brand. This association transfers positive attributes from the influencer to Olipop, reinforcing its image as a health-conscious and trendy beverage choice.

Olipop's multi-faceted marketing strategy effectively combines advertising, celebrity endorsements, strategic partnerships, and influencer collaborations to connect with its health-conscious target market. These efforts, reinforced by thoughtful secondary brand associations and philanthropic initiatives, not only enhance Olipop’s visibility but also strengthen its position as a modern, health-focused, and culturally resonant brand.

Summary. Olipop has established itself as a premium brand in the functional beverage category through its offering of a healthier alternative with health benefits to traditional, sugary, and chemical-filled sodas. Targeting young, health conscious and high-income individuals,

Olipop combines nostalgic flavors and modern wellness by recreating traditional sodas and adding functional ingredients like prebiotics, fiber, and natural sweeteners like botanicals and stevia for a low-calorie, and lower sugar yet classically flavorful drink. It's thoughtfully crafted brand elements such as its packaging (a retro-inspired logo and pastel, flavor-themed colors) and tagline "A New Kind of Soda", effectively communicate the brand's unique value proposition. Positioning itself as a premium product with a higher price point (nearly 2.5 times the price of a regular soda), Olipop emphasizes its superior, natural ingredients and health benefits, resonating with a higher-income, wellness-focused demographic. Olipop utilizes a multi-channel distribution strategy that includes direct-to-consumer subscriptions, retail partnerships with premium stores like WholeFoods, Target and TradeJoes, and foodservice collaborations with companies like Sweetgreen and Starbucks, which further permeates their target audience. Olipop strategically maintains its brand identity through all elements including packaging, distribution, and advertising.

Brand Exploratory

Consumer Knowledge. After interviewing consumers of Olipop (Appendix-A), we discovered many key insights into the perceptions of the brand, including its performance, image, people (perceptions of other consumers of Olipop), negatives, and its advertising. Based on key perceptual insights gathered from consumer interviews, the mental map of Olipop was formed (see Figure 2).

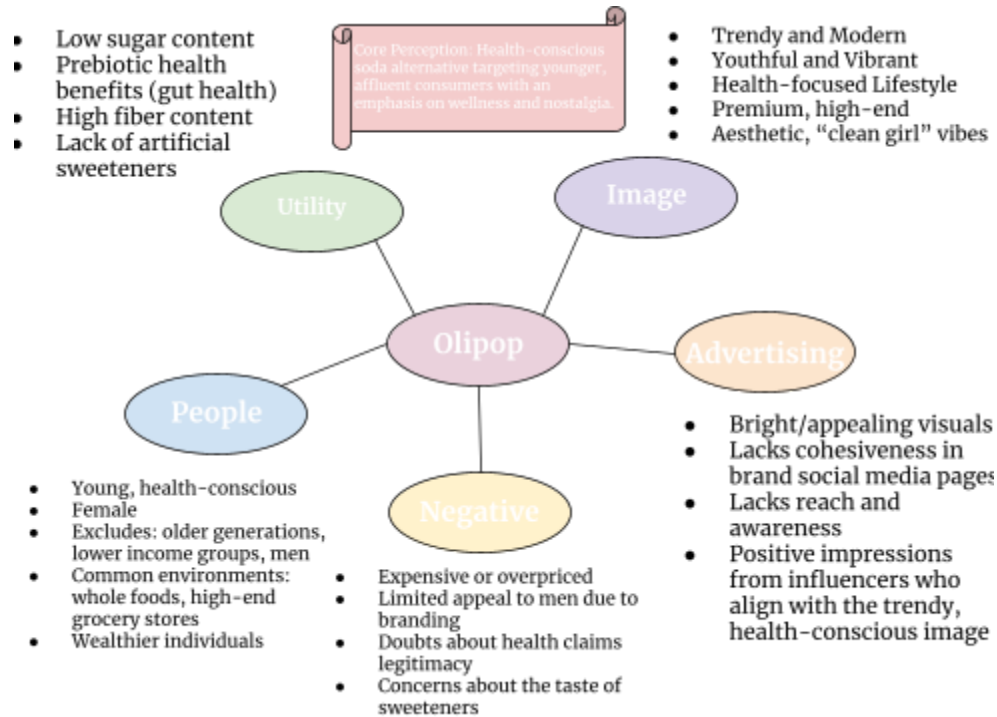


Figure 2. Visual mental map displaying consumer perceptions and associations gathered from consumer interviews.

Utility. Regarding consumer perceptions of the product’s performance, consumers responded that Olipop’s functional health benefits such as its gut health support are the most prominent of the brand. Many praised its low sugar and high fiber content, citing the lack of artificial sweeteners as well as the benefits that come to mind first when they think of Olipop. As consumers looking for healthier soda alternatives, these features were stated to be extremely important to nearly all of the respondents. However, there was some skepticism reported from consumers regarding the validity of these claims of benefit, with consumers concerned about the use of sugar-replacements in Olipop as well as the actual benefits that come from consuming the product. As well, Olipop’s ability to mirror the traditional flavors of classically loved sodas further solidifies its position in the functional beverage market.

Image. Olipop's image in the minds of consumers was stated as trendy, modern, and highly associated with the trending "clean-girl" aesthetic. This trending image is related to females who practice wellness mentally, physically, and emotionally. Therefore, this association of Olipop with this aesthetic was a common, positive note from consumers. Respondents also described the image of the brand as youthful and vibrant, and appealing to health-conscious individuals. The brand is also viewed as a premium product, with its position in higher-end grocery stores such as Whole Foods. However, the image of the brand was also heavily described as female, with nearly all respondents stating that they felt the branding was positioned towards young females, which risks the alienation of male, older consumer demographics.

People. Nearly all respondents cited a version of the word "affluent" in relation to their perception of Olipop consumers. This represents a clear segmentation of Olipop's target market in the eyes of their consumers, as the brand is positioned as a premium, higher priced product. Both the actual pricing of the product as well as its distribution in higher-end stores contribute to this perception. Another highly associated phrase that consumers cited when thinking of Olipop's typical consumer was "young" and "female". While these associations align closely with Olipop's brand image, it runs the risk of excluding male, older, and lower-income individuals as these segmentations may become too stringent.

Advertising. The brand's advertising was widely unknown by interviewees, as many cited they had only seen a few if any advertisements from the brand. Those who did see advertisements from Olipop reported that they often saw them through social media platforms, especially Instagram, and often through brand partnerships with influencers promoting the product. This advertising strategy is aligned with Olipop's brand image, as it emphasizes a resonance with a trendy, health-conscious demographic which usually composes the following of

health influencers on social media. Therefore, this is an effective way for the brand to reach its target audience. Respondents also praised the brand's advertising for its bright, fun visuals. However, many of the interviewees criticized the brand's advertising, citing that it should diversify its approaches by leveraging platforms such as TikTok, significantly increasing its influencer partnerships, as well as adopting a more cohesive brand aesthetic on its social media pages, in order to engage a broader audience. Respondents cited that they rarely saw advertisements from the brand, and that they should also increase their engagement and reach. They also felt that the brand should engage in collaborations which target male consumers to overcome the perception that the brand is solely feminine.

Negatives. Respondents heavily cited pricing as a negative perception they held for Olipop. When asked how they felt about the brand's price, nearly all respondents said that they felt it was overpriced. However, many also then stated that they were willing to pay a higher price for a "healthier soda" over traditional brands. Furthermore, many respondents stated that they were skeptical about the legitimacy of the brand's health claims. Some also questioned the trade-off of replacing sugar with artificial sweeteners. As well, some respondents stated that they felt that the brand's distribution in higher-end stores made it less accessible to certain demographics. A small number of interviewees stated also that they felt the pastel packaging of Olipop was less vibrant and stood out less on the shelves of stores than its competitors, especially Poppi.

Summary of findings. Olipop's mental map reflects a well-aligned brand with trendy and health-conscious, young, female, affluent consumers whose functional health benefits, trendy branding, and nostalgic flavors are its core strengths. However, the brand struggles to expand

with its exclusivity due to high pricing, limited advertising reach, and branding which alienates older, male, and lower-income demographics.

Brand Resonance Pyramid. In order to determine the effectiveness of Olipop’s branding, and how well it resonates with its target audience, we conducted a brand tracking survey among consumers of Olipop (Appendix-B). The questions were blocked into sections which follow the brand resonance pyramid in order to evaluate the brand’s equity among consumers according to its salience, performance, imagery, judgements, feelings, and ultimately, resonance. The figure below shows the brand resonance pyramid that the survey follows.

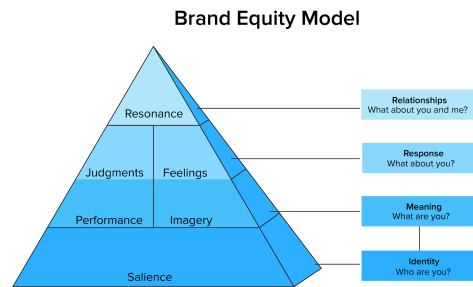


Figure 3

Brand Salience. Olipop demonstrates strong brand salience, particularly in terms of depth and breadth of awareness among surveyed consumers. The survey data reveals that 88% of respondents recognized Olipop as a “healthy soda” or “prebiotic soda” brand, reflecting strong top-of-mind awareness and clear identification within its category (Figure 4). Additionally, 86% of respondents indicated that they had tried Olipop, making it the most sampled brand among competitors in the survey, which included Poppi, Culture Pop Soda, Zevia Zero Sugar Soda, Spade Premium Natural Soda, and Mighty Pop Gut Healthy Soda.

In terms of brand breadth, Olipop has achieved recognition across multiple consumption occasions, such as social events, meals, and as a snack replacement. These varied usage contexts highlight the brand’s situational relevance, reinforcing its positioning as a versatile beverage

option. However, frequency of use remains a challenge. 79% of respondents reported consuming “healthy sodas” either almost never or only once a month, suggesting limited habitual consumption (Figure 5). This finding presents an opportunity for Olipop to deepen brand engagement and encourage more frequent usage through targeted campaigns and incentives. While our survey indicates that curiosity primarily drives initial trials (Figure 6), the brand could improve repeat purchase rates by strengthening communication of its functional benefits (e.g., prebiotic health advantages) and emotional benefits (e.g., unique flavors that evoke enjoyment and nostalgia). Overall, Olipop’s strong brand awareness and trial rates reflect a solid foundation of salience, but addressing gaps in habitual consumption could further enhance its position as a leader in the “healthy soda” category.

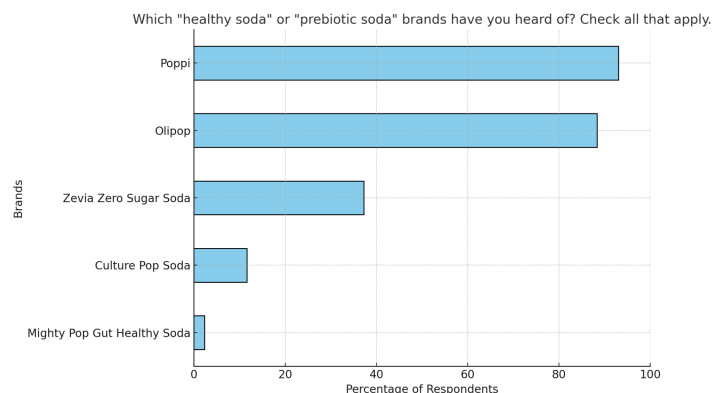


Figure 4

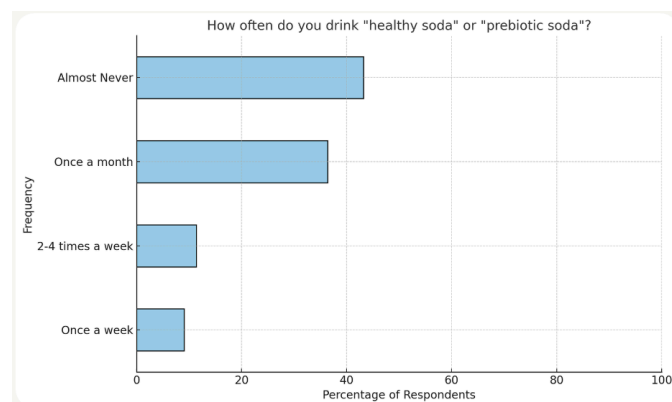


Figure 5

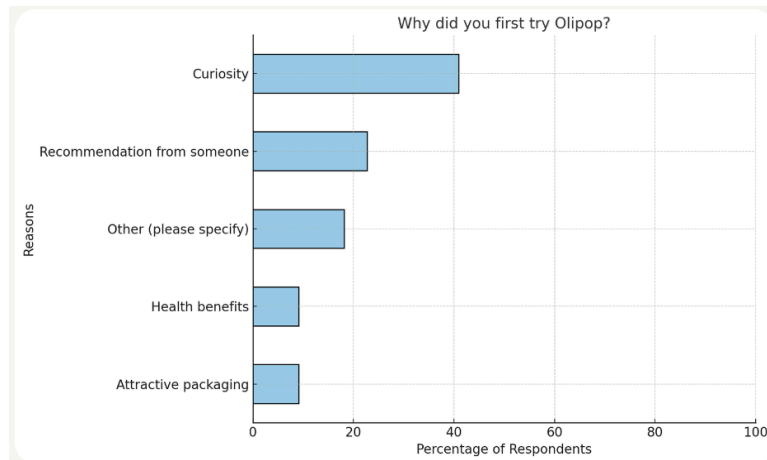


Figure 6

Brand Performance. Olipop excels in several aspects of brand performance, including product quality, packaging design, and consumer trust in its ability to innovate. 73% of respondents agreed that Olipop has a refreshing taste and 73% also felt its packaging stands out on store shelves (Figure 7), reinforcing its appeal as a high-quality and visually distinctive product. Additionally, 63% of respondents expressed that they are either “somewhat likely” or “extremely likely” to try new flavors, indicating trust in the brand’s ability to deliver consistent product experiences. However, perceptions of Olipop’s health benefits present opportunity for improvement, as only 14% strongly agreed that Olipop helps with digestion (Figure 7). Pricing also remains a critical challenge, with 45% providing neutral feedback on value for money and 30% feeling either somewhat dissatisfied or extremely dissatisfied. These insights suggest that while Olipop performs well in product design and innovation, addressing perceptions of health benefits and affordability could boost their brand performance.

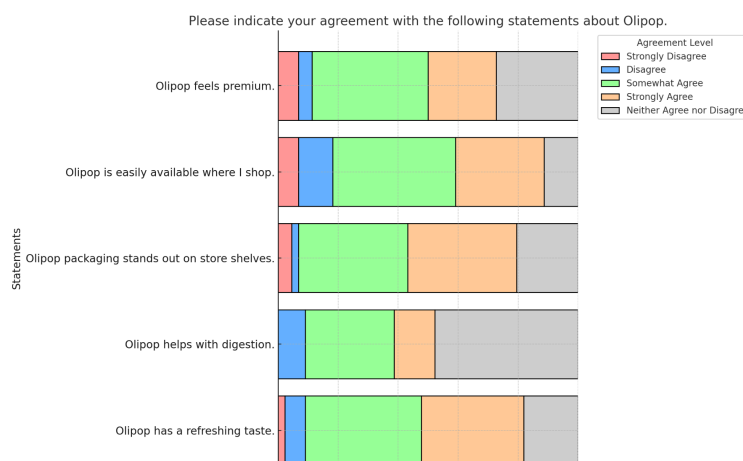


Figure 7

Brand Imagery. Olipop's brand imagery reflects a strong alignment with modern, health-conscious lifestyles while emphasizing fun and trendiness. Many respondents indicated that drinking Olipop either makes them feel trendy (41%) or health conscious (36%), highlighting the brand's success in projecting a contemporary and wellness-oriented image (Figure 9a). Additionally, Olipop was overwhelmingly described as fun (95%) and modern (86%), emphasizing its vibrant and current brand personality. However, perceptions of trustworthiness and premiumness were less consistent (Figure 8). Olipop's user profile is most commonly associated with college students, health enthusiasts, and young professionals, which aligns well with its target demographic (Figure 9b). In terms of usage, Olipop is frequently seen being consumed during casual gatherings and at home, indicating versatility but also suggesting potential to expand more into niche situations, such as fitness or dining. To improve brand imagery, Olipop could focus on strengthening perceptions of trustworthiness and premiumness while expanding its relevance in specific lifestyle scenarios that resonate with its existing audience.

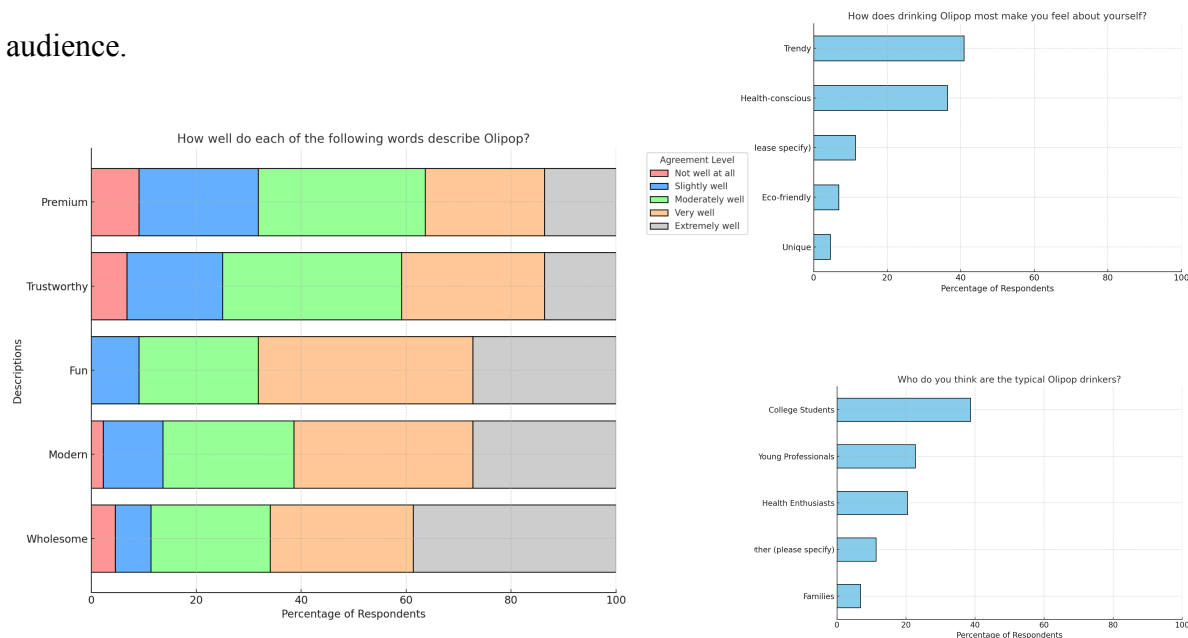


Figure 8

Figure 9a, 9b

Brand Judgements. Our survey findings on brand judgements reveal positive consumer perceptions of Olipop but highlight areas for improvement in differentiation and advocacy. The majority of respondents held a favorable view of Olipop (70%), with 48% rating it “somewhat favorable” and 22% as “very favorable”. When asked how well Olipop meets expectations for taste, 73% of respondents rate it “well” or better. Expectations for health benefits are slightly less consistently met, with 61% of respondents rating it “well” or better. Compared to competitors, 55% felt Olipop performs “about the same,” while 18% responded “somewhat better” and another 14% responded “much better”. Their key strengths include attractive packaging, flavor options, and taste (Figure 10), while areas for improvement include advertising, perceived health benefits, and strategic partnerships, which were noted as weaknesses relative to competitors. While advocacy potential is solid, with 55% indicating they would recommend Olipop, neutral or negative opinions suggest the need for targeted efforts to strengthen differentiation and loyalty.

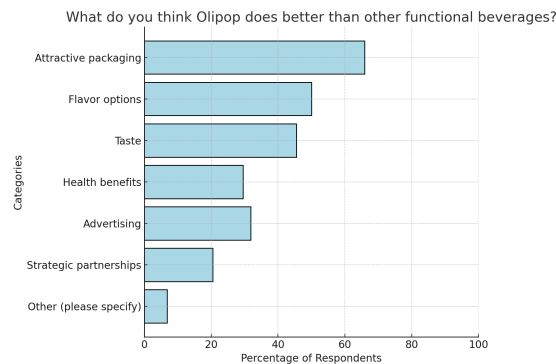


Figure 10

Brand Feelings. Brand feelings about Olipop reflect their strength in evoking fun and excitement but highlight weaknesses in fostering deeper emotional connections. 76% of

respondents associated Olipop with feelings of fun, and 32% linked it to excitement, proving its appeal as a lighthearted and enjoyable brand. However, fewer respondents felt it inspired self-respect or social approval, suggesting limited alignment with aspirational or communal emotions (Figure 11). While 55% either somewhat agree or strongly agree that Olipop makes them feel proud to support a better beverage option and 41% feel confident in their choices, fewer respondents are inspired to be healthier from drinking Olipop (Figure 12). Additionally, 70% of survey participants felt that Olipop contributes little or nothing to their overall wellbeing, identifying a chance to better communicate its functional and emotional benefits. When directly asking survey participants what they would change about Olipop, responses centered on lowering prices, broadening flavor options, and increasing advertising, all of which could strengthen the brand’s emotional resonance.

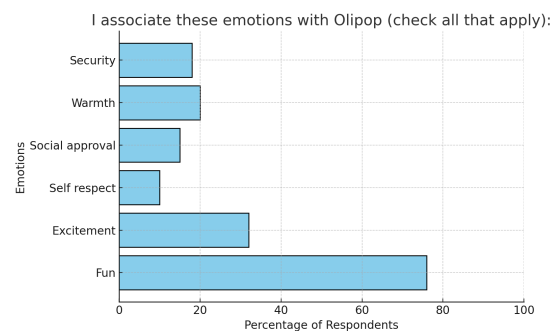


Figure 11

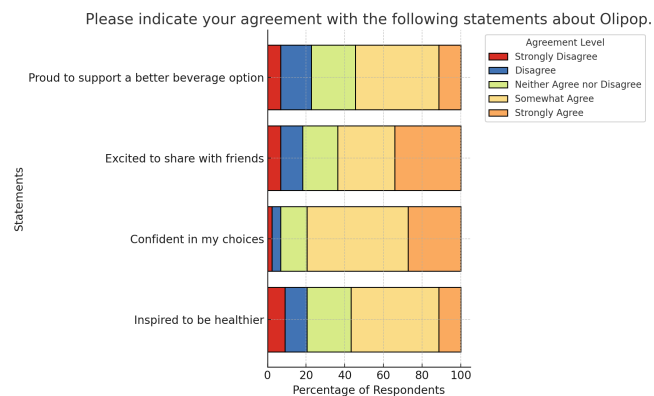


Figure 12

Brand Resonance. Olipop’s brand resonance remains underdeveloped, with limited consumer advocacy, engagement, and loyalty. The majority of respondents (70%) disagree or strongly disagreed with regularly talking about Olipop with friends and family, and 82% expressed low engagement with the brand on social media (Figure 13). Moreover, 70% of respondents indicated they did not feel a part of the Olipop community, stressing a lack of emotional connection and shared identity among its consumers. A deeper dive into this statistic revealed that the majority of those who responded “strongly disagree” to this statement were of the male gender, as seen in the demographics section of our survey. While some respondents (23%) expressed excitement for new product or flavor releases (Figure 13), this enthusiasm has not translated into deeper loyalty, as 77% reported they were somewhat unlikely or extremely unlikely to join Olipop’s subscription program, and almost identical statistics showed the same unlikelihood of respondents buying Olipop-branded merchandise. These findings encourage Olipop to build stronger resonance by fostering community engagement and exploring loyalty initiatives that resonate more effectively with its target audience, and more specifically finding a way to better target their male audience.

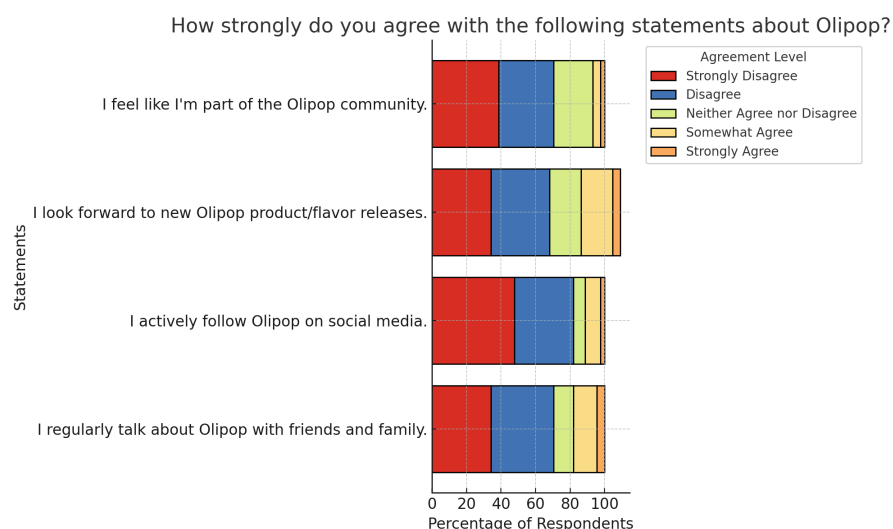


Figure 13

Competition. The primary direct competitors of Olipop in the “health soda” functional beverage category are Poppi and Zevia. Both Brands offer alternative, healthier soda options, as they are carbonated beverages like soda which utilize sugar alternatives. They both also market to the same audiences: health-conscious consumers.

Poppi. Poppi is a direct competitor of Olipop and offers an extremely similar product, with similar marketed health benefits. Both claim to promote gut health. Poppi advertises its main benefit stemming from its use of apple cider vinegar, and markets to young, health conscious, trendy individuals.

Points of Parity. The functional benefits of Poppi are marketed virtually the same as Olipop, as they claim to promote gut-health, overall wellness, and lack the harmful chemicals and sugar of traditional sodas. They both appeal to a young, health conscious consumer, especially millennials and Gen-Z who are invested in health and wellness, and are also usually into trendy products. Both brands also offer a wide variety of flavors that replicate traditional soda tastes (cola, root beer). Both brands also utilize a vibrant, colorful and aesthetic packaging.

Points of Difference. Regarding functional benefits, their core ingredient differs. Poppi’s main marketed ingredient is their use of apple cider vinegar, and their marketing surrounds the trending health benefits of apple cider vinegar: improved gut health. Apple cider has strong consumer recognition as a healthy ingredient. Olipop advertises their use of botanicals, plant fiber, and prebiotics as the source of their gut-healthy ingredients, and utilizes a wider range of these ingredients. Their taste is described as a point of difference among consumers, with Poppi being described as a lighter, seltzer-water like flavor. Olipop is described as more flavorful,

replicating the traditional flavors of soda. Their brand personality slightly differs as Poppi leans into modern, trendy branding with brighter colors in their packaging, and unique flavors. Olipop, on the other hand, leans into a more nostalgic vibe with their packaging, utilizing a vintage aesthetic and pastel colors which aligns with their overall branding as a remake of traditional “pop”.

Brand Mantra. Poppi’s brand mantra, “Be Gut Happy. Be Gut Healthy” emphasizes its heavy focus on gut health, and its playful, fun brand personality. Olipop’s brand mantra, “A New Kind of Soda” emphasizes its remake of traditional, nostalgic soda with added functional health benefits. In this way, Olipop’s brand mantra is broader, and more versatile, as it communicates the brand’s focus on overall modern wellness while maintaining the vintage feel of traditionally loved sodas.

Zevia. Zevia is another prominent brand in the functional beverage category, offering a zero-calorie soda alternative. It is marketed as “guilt-free”, compared to traditional sugary sodas, with a focus on natural, zero calorie sweetener.

Points of Parity. Both Olipop and Zevia offer a healthier alternative to traditional sodas, with carbonated, canned, flavored beverages which lack the high-calorie, sugar, and harmful chemicals found in traditional sodas. They are both positioned as healthy beverages for those looking to replace soda. They both offer a wide range of flavor options, many of which both mimic the traditional flavors of soda like cola and ginger ale. The brands both utilize visually appealing packaging, though they differ greatly in aesthetics.

Points of difference. Once again the main ingredient marketed in the products differ, as Zevia emphasizes their exclusive use of Stevia to replace sugar. Zevia is marketed primarily as a zero-calorie beverage, using natural sweetener, and lacking harmful ingredients. Olipop on the

other hand markets a much more holistically healthy beverage, utilizing plant fiber, prebiotics, and botanicals, and marketing their product as not only lacking harmful ingredients, but having a gut health and overall wellness benefit added. Zevia lacks these health claims, and focuses more on the zero-calorie, no sugar aspect of their branding. Regarding their target audiences, Zevia appeals to a broader range of consumers including those who are focused on weight management, calorie control, and replacing a habit for soda. Olipop targets a younger, trendier, health and wellness focused consumer.

Brand Mantra. Zevia’s brand mantra, “Smarter Soda Choices”, conveys its emphasis on its healthy, guilt-free product, for consumers who are counting calories and watching their weight. Olipop’s brand mantra, “A New Kind of Soda”, conveys its mission to improve overall health with innovative ingredients while maintaining the nostalgia of traditional soda.

Summary. Olipop, despite having a very similar direct competitor, stands out for its unique and innovative blend of health-beneficial ingredients and nostalgic branding. Olipop differentiates itself with a richer, soda-like flavor, and wider range of beneficial ingredients which promote a holistic health benefit, rather than one aspect of gut health or calorie-free like its competitors. To strengthen its competitive position, Olipop can further emphasize its functional benefits while addressing concerns around accessibility and taste.

<i>Aspect</i>	<i>Olipop</i>	<i>Poppi</i>	<i>Zevia</i>
<i>Target market</i>	Health-conscious millennials and Gen-Z, trendy, wellness oriented	Trendy, youthful consumers, millennials and gen-z health conscious and wellness oriented	Broader audience, calorie-conscious individuals
<i>Core Ingredient</i>	Prebiotics, botanicals, plant fiber	Apple Cider Vinegar	Stevia
<i>Positioning</i>	Nostalgic, functional	Modern, gut healthy	Zero-Calorie

	soda	soda	Alternative
<i>Taste Profile</i>	Rich, soda-like	Light, sparkling water like	Sweetened with Stevia
<i>Mantra</i>	“A New Kind of Soda”	“ Be Gut Happy. Be Gut Healthy”	“Smarter Soda Choices”

Figure 14. A table showing the three brands points of parity and points of differences.

Recommendations

Strategic. Olipop’s current positioning centers around it being a functional, health-conscious alternative to traditional sodas. Its core points of parity are its offering of lower-sugar, gut-healthy ingredients. The core points of difference which help to distinguish Olipop are its specific unique blend of ingredients which include prebiotics and botanicals which support gut health, its nostalgic, traditionally-inspired flavors, high fiber content, and overall focus on holistic wellness and health habits rather than stressing “calorie-free” or specifically digestion.

Weaknesses identified in the brand resonance pyramid for Olipop include low habitual usage, lack of inclusivity for men, and low perceived health benefits that cause confusion for the high price. In order to overcome these weaknesses, Olipop should reposition itself in the future as a “lifestyle enhancer” rather than simply a functional beverage supporting “gut health”. This new positioning would center around value perception, community-centric branding, and accessibility. Highlighting the premium quality and range of ingredients in Olipop would better support the premium pricing strategy, and consumers would better understand that they are paying for a premium product with a unique blend of ingredients including prebiotics, botanicals, and plant fiber (unlike competitors), which supports their overall health, and would justify the

higher price in their minds. Fostering stronger emotional resonance within the minds of consumers through community centric branding would strengthen brand resonance. Through fostering inclusivity and a shared wellness experience, consumers can feel that they are a part of a community of people who use Olipop, which transforms the drink from just a product into a lifestyle. Furthermore, accessibility is a large area for improvement for Olipop, as it can broaden its appeal to casual soda drinkers to encourage more frequent consumption, rather than its niche appeal to its target audience of young, health-conscious, trendy individuals who are interested in trending and expensive products. By widening the appeal of the brand to more everyday consumers, the brand can improve its usage rates and eventually develop stronger, deeper brand loyalty among consumers.

Furthermore, consumers responded that they most often drink prebiotic sodas with meals, as a snack, or during social events. In order to improve the weakness of low habitual usage, Olipop should redirect its advertising to emphasize the benefits of drinking Olipop before bed. Many individuals take daily vitamins or pre/probiotics in pill form before bed, and Olipop can reposition its advertising to suggest daily, habitual use by further highlighting the benefit of drinking an Olipop before bed. As well, the advertising can take advantage of the trending social media “sleepy girl mocktail” where influencers and consumers alike have made bedtime drinks utilizing Olipop’s or Poppi’s. Further advertising the beverage’s ability to work as a daily health improvement product, would increase habitual use as well as its positioning as an overall health and wellness enhancing product.

By targeting these areas of improvement, the brand can broaden its appeal to a wider audience, increase its usage, increase consumer emotional resonance, and overcome a high price perception. Olipop should position itself so that consumers view it as an overall lifestyle

improvement, rather than just a soda with a gut healthy ingredient. The new positioning statement for Olipop should center around the idea that “Olipop is the ultimate beverage experience- where nostalgic flavors meet modern health benefits, making every sip a step toward a happier, healthier you.” This positioning statement reflects a movement towards highlighting an overall lifestyle improvement with the product, emphasizing an emotional connection to the brand, as consumers feel they are working towards a better version of themselves.

New brand Mantras. Utilizing insights from the mental map, we propose the following brand mantra for Olipop, “ Flavor, Wellness, Together.” This simple yet impactful brand mantra would better encapsulate the core values and attributes of Olipop, especially with its brand repositioning. The flavor component of the brand mantra highlights Olipop’s ability to deliver bold, classically inspired soda tastes that consistently deliver a high level of satisfaction. It also emphasizes the fact that without satisfying the flavor, the other benefits of the drink are nearly useless. The wellness component highlights that Olipop provides a holistic wellness benefit including improved digestion and gut health, plant fiber, and prebiotics that improve overall health. Finally, the together component underscores the brand’s ability to build a community of health-conscious individuals who are on the journey to better living together.

Tactical. The tactical recommendations for Olipop focus on addressing key areas of improvement identified in consumer research. The Bedtime Bliss Campaign introduces a new usage occasion of bedtime—through sleep-promoting flavors, “Nightly Ritual Box” PR packages, and ASMR-style ads—encouraging habitual consumption while reinforcing relaxation and wellness associations. A Male-Targeted Collaboration aims to expand Olipop’s demographic reach by partnering with male influencers like Joe Rogan and introducing gender-neutral packaging, addressing perceptions of exclusivity in the brand’s audience. Finally, a Back-of-Can

Packaging Redesign enhances ingredient transparency and retail appeal with graphics and concise messaging, emphasizing Olipop's functional benefits and justifying its premium price. Together, these initiatives strengthen brand equity while addressing consumer concerns and broadening Olipop's appeal.

Bedtime Bliss Campaign. The Bedtime Bliss campaign will directly respond to Olipop's need for increased habitual usage of their product by introducing a new daily usage situation: bedtime. This idea stems from the fact that many health-conscious individuals who take prebiotic supplements in pill-form tend to take them before bed in order to reduce excessive bloating throughout the day. Upon further research we found that prebiotic soda works just as well as prebiotic pills, thus they serve the same purpose as a supplement. In fact, Olipop actually includes almost double the amount of prebiotic fiber in comparison to a generic prebiotic capsule. So, if users take prebiotic pills at bedtime, why shouldn't they drink Olipop at bedtime? Well the answer is— they should— they've just never been told to. The Bedtime Bliss campaign consists of a duo flavor introduction that uses sleep-promoting ingredients— Chamomile and Lavender Lemonade— which would fall under Olipop's "Herbal & Refreshing" product category (Figure 15). PR packages sent to health-oriented influencers would be coined "Nightly Ritual Boxes" that include these nighttime-inspired beverages, a pair of Olipop-branded PJ's, and a sleep mask (Figure 16). Social media posts of the "Nightly Ritual Boxes" would allow viewers to associate the brand with the concept of nighttime consumption, which further increases likelihood of ritual consumption. Besides influencer generated content, Olipop should release advertisements for the new bedtime flavors in the form of short, meditative bedtime stories or ASMR-style ads to not only increase habitual usage but to create brand associations such as relaxation, comfort, and calmness. ASMR-style ads would be especially effective because

opening soda cans is a popular ASMR trigger (i.e, a sound that's well-known for being satisfying and relaxing). Lastly, Olipop could potentially add a partner to this collaboration if needed, and we recommend Lemme Sleep. This melatonin gummy brand founded by Kourtney Kardashian would not only help introduce Olipop to consumers of sleep-enhancing products, but it would also help attract customers that are already comfortable spending extra money on premium products. This campaign effectively addresses the need for perceived benefits of habitual usage and seamlessly aligns with the products' prebiotic components which are usually consumed in other forms before bed.



Figure 15. Rough mock-up of Olipop's sleep-promoting Lavender Lemonade (left) and Calming Chamomile (right) flavors.



Figure 16. Inspiration for “Nightly Ritual Box” PR Packages for Influencers.

Male-Targeted Collaborations. Many of the male participants in our interviews highlighted that they felt excluded from Olipop’s target demographic. Additionally, some even felt “embarrassed to be seen holding the can” as they felt the packaging looked “girly”. This insight also reflected the fact that all of Olipop’s sports sponsorships and celebrity endorsements have been with female teams and celebrities. To combat this issue, Olipop should collaborate with more male celebrities and influencers in addition to showing more male representation in their advertisements. A specific male collaboration could be Joe Rogan, a podcaster and UFC commentator who many males listen to for advice— especially when it comes to health products. For example, Rogan partnered with brain-health supplement company NeuroGum, and upon his first promotion of the product, NeuroGum’s equity skyrocketed, making him a secure choice for male partnerships. The collaboration could include Rogan’s favorite flavor with specialized

packaging of a darker, more gender-neutral colored can. He is a health-oriented celebrity who is viewed as traditionally “manly”, which would make men feel more confident in carrying an Olipop can. This recommendation expands Olipop’s demographic reach, addressing concerns of being a female-centric brand while still aligning with its functional benefits.

Back-of-Can Packaging Redesign. To address consumer skepticism about Olipop’s health benefits and justify its premium price, retail messaging and packaging should focus on clear, visually engaging communication about its unique ingredients and their superior quality. Currently, the back of the can includes two paragraphs that lack the eye-catching appeal needed to capture attention (Figure 17). As seen in the figure, by incorporating simple graphics depicting key ingredients—such as prebiotics, botanicals, and plant fiber—along with concise, impactful statements like “9g of fiber in every can—32% of your daily value, in flavors you love!” Olipop can quickly educate consumers at the point of purchase. This redesign would not only make the product's benefits more noticeable but also differentiate Olipop from competitors like Poppi or Zevia by emphasizing its scientific, high-quality blend of functional ingredients. Highlighting these unique selling points directly on the packaging ensures that even casual shoppers can immediately recognize Olipop’s added value, making the higher price point feel more justified and increasing their likelihood to purchase.



Figure 17. Olipop's current back-of-can packaging design (left) and a rough mock-up of Olipop's back-of-can packaging redesign (right).

Conclusion

Our brand audit of Olipop reveals a company with a strong foundation in innovation, nostalgia, and health-consciousness. By combining functional ingredients with the emotional appeal of traditional soda flavors, Olipop has cultivated a unique identity in the competitive functional beverage market. Its strengths lie in its distinct branding, diverse product portfolio, and alignment with the values of younger, health-focused consumers. However, challenges such as limited habitual use, perceptions of exclusivity, and skepticism about health claims highlight areas for growth. By addressing these gaps, Olipop has the potential to deepen consumer loyalty, expand its market reach, and solidify its position as a leader in the "healthy soda" category.

Appendix-A: Consumer Interviews

Link to Interview Questions and Responses:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1U1O_2Vqp0qQRr7x_m8QmTSg94sourVKHwIZsjhk_H6Q/edit?usp=sharing

Appendix-B: Brand Tracking Survey

Brand Salience:

Which "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda" brands have you heard of? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q2 - Which "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda" brands have you heard of? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice ↓

Percentage

Zevia Zero Sugar Soda	36%
Poppi	93%
Olipop	89%
Mighty Pop Gut Healthy Soda	2%
Culture Pop Soda	11%

Have you ever tried any of these "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda" brands? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q21 - Have you ever tried any of these "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda" brands? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice

Percentage

Olipop	84%
Poppi	81%
Culture Pop Soda	2%
Zevia Zero Sugar Soda	16%

If you were to reach for a "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda", which brands would you gravitate towards? ⓘ

Q22 - If you were to reach for a "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda", which brands would you gravitate towards? - Selected Choice	Percentage
Olipop	68%
Poppi	59%
Culture Pop Soda	2%
Zevia Zero Sugar Soda	7%
Other (please specify)	2%

How often do you drink "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda"? ⓘ

Q4 - How often do you drink "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda"?	Percentage
Almost Never	44%
Once a month	36%
Once a week	9%
2-4 times a week	11%

When you buy "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda", which quantity do you buy? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q7 - When you buy "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda", which quantity do you buy? Check all that apply.	Percentage
Single cans	74%
4 pack	53%
12 pack	13%

Which occasions do you typically drink "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda"? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q16 - Which occasions do you typically drink "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda"? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice	Percentage
With meals	37%
As a snack replacement	37%
Post-workout	11%
Social events	35%
Other (please specify)	13%

Where do you buy "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda"? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q8 - Where do you buy "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda"? Check all that apply.	Percentage
Grocery store	91%
Convenience store	17%
Brand website	2%
Amazon	7%

How often do you purchase Olipop? ⓘ

Q5 - How often do you purchase Olipop?	Percentage
Weekly	9%
Monthly	28%
Rarely	30%
Never	30%

Which Olipop flavors have you tried? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q6 - Which Olipop flavors have you tried? Check all that apply.	Percentage
Vintage Cola	38%
Crisp Apple	15%
Ridge Rush	5%
Classic Root Beer	30%
Classic Grape	13%
Cream Soda	38%
Peaches & Cream	13%

Where have you heard about Olipop? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q14 - Where have you heard about Olipop? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice	Percentage
TV ads	13%
Retail store displays	33%
Online ads	26%
Social media	59%
Influencer partnerships	50%
Word of mouth	59%
Other (please specify)	7%

Why did you first try Olipop? ⓘ

Q15 - Why did you first try Olipop? - Selected Choice	Percentage
Curiosity	39%
Health benefits	9%
Recommendation from someone	24%
Attractive packaging	9%
Other (please specify)	17%

Brand Performance:

- Statistics showing averages reference a 5-point scale with 1 being lowest agreement and 5 being highest agreement.

Please indicate your agreement with the following statements about Olipop. ⓘ

Please indicate your agreement with the following statements about Olipop.	Average
Olipop has a refreshing taste.	3.96
Olipop helps with digestion.	3.47
Olipop packaging stands out on store shelves.	3.98
Olipop is easily available where I shop.	3.76
Olipop feels premium.	3.67

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How satisfied are you with Olipop's price? ⓘ

Q25 - How satisfied are you with Olipop's price?	Percentage
Extremely dissatisfied	4%
Somewhat dissatisfied	24%
Neutral	47%
Somewhat satisfied	20%
Extremely satisfied	4%

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If Olipop introduced new flavors, how likely would you be to try them? ⓘ

Q26 - If Olipop introduced new flavors, how likely would you be to try them?	Percentage
Extremely unlikely	9%
Somewhat unlikely	9%
Neither likely nor unlikely	18%
Somewhat likely	49%
Extremely likely	16%

How would you rate Olipop's packaging design? ⓘ

Q27 - How would you rate Olipop's packaging design?	Percentage
Poor	2%
Fair	7%
Good	31%
Very Good	31%
Excellent	29%

Brand Imagery:

- Statistics showing averages reference a 5-point scale with 1 being “not well at all” and 5 being “extremely well”.

How well do each of the following words describe Olipop? ⓘ

How well do each of the following words describe Olipop?	Average
Wholesome	2.76
Modern	3.67
Fun	3.91
Trustworthy	3.02
Premium	3.33

Who do you think are the typical Olipop drinkers? ⓘ

Q30 - Who do you think are the typical Olipop drinkers? - Selected Choice	Percentage
Young Professionals	22%
College Students	40%
Families	7%
Health Enthusiasts	20%
Other (please specify)	11%

In what situations do you see Olipop being consumed? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q31 - In what situations do you see Olipop being consumed? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice	Percentage
Casual gatherings	67%
At the office	33%
During class	49%
During workouts	18%
At home	78%
Other (please specify)	2%

Brand Judgements:

How would you rate your overall opinion of Olipop? ⓘ

Q9 - How would you rate your overall opinion of Olipop?	Percentage
Very unfavorable	2%
Somewhat unfavorable	9%
Indifferent/ No opinion	20%
Somewhat favorable	46%
Very favorable	22%

How well does Olipop meet your expectations for taste? ⓘ

Q10 - How well does Olipop meet your expectations for taste?	Percentage
Not well at all	7%
Slightly well	22%
Well	35%
Very well	20%
Extremely well	17%

How well does Olipop meet your expectations for health benefits? ⓘ

Q17 - How well does Olipop meet your expectations for health benefits?	Percentage
Not well at all	7%
Slightly well	30%
Well	43%
Very well	13%
Extremely well	7%

How would you compare Olipop to other "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda" brands you've tried? ⓘ

Q18 - How would you compare Olipop to other "healthy soda" or "prebiotic soda" brands you've tried?	Percentage
Much worse	2%
Somewhat worse	11%
About the same	54%
Somewhat better	20%
Much better	13%

What do you think Olipop does better than other functional beverages? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q19 - What do you think Olipop does better than other functional beverages? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice	Percentage
Attractive packaging	65%
Flavor options	48%
Taste	43%
Health benefits	28%
Advertising	33%
Strategic partnerships	20%

What do you think Olipop does worse than other functional beverages? Check all that apply. ⓘ

Q23 - What do you think Olipop does worse than other functional beverages? Check all that apply. - Selected Choice	Percentage
Attractive packaging	15%
Flavor options	15%
Taste	24%
Health benefits	15%
Advertising	37%
Strategic partnerships	29%

Would you recommend Olipop to others? ⓘ

Q13 - Would you recommend Olipop to others?	Percentage
Definitely would not	7%
Probably would not	9%
Neutral	33%
Probably would	26%
Definitely would	26%

Brand Feelings:

How does drinking Olipop most make you feel about yourself? ⓘ

Q28 - How does drinking Olipop most make you feel about yourself? - Selected Choice	Percentage
Health-conscious	38%
Trendy	40%
Unique	4%
Eco-friendly	7%
Other (please specify)	11%

When I think of Olipop, I feel... ⓘ	...				
When I think of Olipop, I feel... ↑	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat agree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Strongly Agree
Inspired to be healthier	11%	9%	23%	45%	11%
Confident in my choices	5%	2%	27%	52%	14%
Excited to share with friends	11%	18%	30%	34%	7%
Proud to support a better beverage option	7%	16%	43%	23%	11%

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How much does Olipop contribute to your overall well-being? ⓘ					
Q34 - How much does Olipop contribute to your overall well-being?	Percentage				
None at all	41%				
A little	30%				
A moderate amount	23%				
A lot	2%				
A great deal	5%				

Brand Resonance:

How strongly do you agree with the following statements? ⓘ	...				
How strongly do you agree with the following statements? ↑	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Somewhat agree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Strongly Agree
I regularly talk about Olipop with friends and family.	34%	36%	11%	14%	5%
I actively follow Olipop on social media.	48%	34%	7%	9%	2%
I look forward to new Olipop product/flavor releases.	34%	18%	18%	25%	5%
I feel like I'm part of the Olipop community	39%	32%	5%	23%	2%

How likely are you to join an Olipop subscription program? ⓘ

Q37 - How likely are you to join an Olipop subscription program?	Percentage
Extremely unlikely	55%
Somewhat unlikely	20%
Neither likely nor unlikely	14%
Somewhat likely	11%

If Olipop offered merchandise, how likely would you be to purchase it? ⓘ

Q38 - If Olipop offered merchandise, how likely would you be to purchase it?	Percentage
Extremely unlikely	66%
Somewhat unlikely	11%
Neither likely or unlikely	11%
Somewhat likely	11%

Demographics:

How old are you? ⓘ

Q40 - How old are you?	Percentage
18-24	84%
25-34	7%
45-54	2%
55+	7%

What is your gender? ⓘ

Q39 - What is your gender?	Percentage
Male	14%
Female	84%
Prefer not to say	2%

What is the highest level of education you have completed? ⓘ

Q41 - What is the highest level of education you have completed?	Percentage
High School diploma or equivalent	14%
Some college	70%
Bachelor's Degree	11%
Master's Degree or Higher	5%

How do you identify your ethnicity? ⓘ

Q42 - How do you identify your ethnicity? - Selected Choice	Percentage
Asian	7%
Caucasian/ White	82%
Hispanic/Latino	9%
Other (Please Specify) :	2%

What is your annual household income? ⓘ

Q43 - What is your annual household income?	Percentage
Under 25,000	21%
25,000 - 49,999	7%
50,000 - 74,499	5%
75,000 - 99,999	2%
100,000 - 149,999	7%
150,000 +	58%

What is your marital status? ⓘ

Q44 - What is your marital status?	Percentage
Single	82%
Married	9%
Divorced	5%
Widowed	5%

What description best describes where you are located? ⓘ

Q45 - What description best describes where you are located?	Percentage
Suburban area	70%
Urban area	30%

What is your employment status? ⓘ

Q46 - What is your employment status?	Percentage
Employed Full- Time	9%
Employed Part- Time	11%
Unemployed	2%
Student	68%
Retired	9%

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<https://www.starbucks.com/menu/drinks/bottled-beverages/kombucha-and-soda>

Teamwork Distribution - Emma, Liv, Both of us

1. Introduction: [2.5 points]

- a. Provide the brand history and describe their target market.
 - i. Evaluate past records of the brand, i.e., past marketing activities, blogs, and newspaper/magazine articles on the brand.
- b. Delve into their product portfolio of offerings. See if you can compartmentalize them into unique product categories (see Figure 9)

2. Brand Inventory: [15 points]

- a. Products – What makes the products different or unique from the competition? Dig deep into the attributes and benefits associated with the brand's products. I encourage you to sample a few of their products to get first-hand experience.
- b. Brand elements – Which brand elements does the brand emphasize on? Which is the most prominent? How and where are they utilized? Are they all consistent or are there different versions for no obvious reasons? Give reasons.
- c. Pricing – Is the brand high-end? What is the range of prices for their products? Do they charge a premium? Do you see a value offering, meaning, will consumers be interested in paying a premium for the product? Is the pricing associated or aligned with their brand image and target market? Give reasons.
- d. Distribution – What channels does the brand use to distribute their products (direct, indirect, or online)? Provide rationale as to the appropriateness of the current channels (think of target market).
- e. Marketing and communication strategy – Look at recent campaigns and describe the different communication strategies that were utilized to promote the brand – advertising, brand ambassadors, sponsorships, philanthropy, etc. Are there any secondary brand entities (Ch-8) that the brand associates itself with? If yes, please elaborate.
- f. Provide a summary of key points.

3. Brand Exploratory: [30 points]

– Conducted Interviews, Created & Distributed Survey –

- a. Consumer knowledge – Briefly interview 25 family and/or friends (not team member) and explore their perceptions of the brand (awareness and image). Look for associations that can help you build a mental map. You would then have to categorize them into core brand associations and label them accordingly. The categories would give a sense of the brand's POPs and PODs (see Figure 9-9, Rolex Mental Map, p. 326).
- b. Brand resonance pyramid – Briefly apply the brand resonance model and see where the brand stands. Specifically, request the same sample of family/friends (n = 25) to fill out the brand tracking survey and on analyzing the data, evaluate which components the brand is doing well or not well on and where should improvements be made?
- c. Competition – Who is the competition [select a total of two direct competitors]? Elaborate on each competitor and explain on what aspects (POPs and PODs) do they compete with the brand. Furthermore, compare each brand's mantra (i.e., brand vs. competitors).
- d. Provide a summary of key points.

4. Recommendations: [10 points]

- a. Strategic (positioning):
 - i. Based on the POPs and PODs – how do you think the brand should position itself in the future?
 - ii. With the new positioning, provide a 'new' brand mantra.
- b. Tactical:
 - i. Think of three (or more) possible opportunities that can be implemented to help the brand enhance its equity. Elaborate on each opportunity

Conclusion